



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Latvia. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in Danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing a bit about yourself! Since you're 16, have completed primary school in Denmark, and are fluent in Danish, you're at a natural decision point where you can choose between different upper secondary education options based on your interests, goals, and future plans.

Here are the main educational paths available in Denmark after primary school, with pros and cons for each to help guide you:

1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (Upper Secondary Education - Academic Pathways)

These are typically 3-year programs that prepare you for higher education (university or professional bachelor's degrees).

♦ STX (Studentereksamen) – General upper secondary education

- **Focus:** Broad range of academic subjects (science, social studies, languages, etc.)
- **Best for:** Students who want to keep options open for university
- **Pro:** Versatile; many higher education options afterward
- **Con:** Can be quite theoretical; not ideal if you prefer hands-on learning

♦ HHX (Higher Commercial Examination Programme)

- **Focus:** Business, economics, marketing, and languages
- **Best for:** Those interested in business, trade, or economics
- **Pro:** Strong foundation for business-related university programs or starting a business
- **Con:** Less focus on science or arts

♦ HTX (Higher Technical Examination Programme)

- **Focus:** Science, technology, IT, and engineering
- **Best for:** Tech-savvy students or those interested in STEM fields
- **Pro:** Prepares well for technical university degrees
- **Con:** More specialized – not ideal if your interests are in humanities or business

♦ HF (Higher Preparatory Examination)

- **Focus:** A more flexible, 2-year academic program
- **Best for:** Students who want a shorter upper secondary path or didn't get strong grades

- **Pro:** Good second chance route to higher education
- **Con:** Fewer subjects than STX, and not all universities accept HF for every program

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training - EUD/EUX)

These programs combine school and practical training and usually take 3-5 years. You'll often get paid during your apprenticeship.

♦ EUD (Vocational Education)

- **Focus:** Practical skills for a specific trade (e.g. electrician, hairdresser, mechanic, chef)
- **Pro:** You learn a trade and can go straight to work
- **Con:** Less flexible if you later want to go to university

♦ EUX (Combination of Vocational + Academic)

- **Focus:** Combines vocational training with upper secondary courses, allowing university access
- **Pro:** Best of both worlds – a trade and possibility to continue to university
- **Con:** Very demanding; requires strong motivation

3. International Options (if you're thinking beyond Denmark or want to use your Latvian background)

- **International Baccalaureate (IB):** Taught in English, recognized worldwide. Good if you're considering studying abroad.
- **Language-focused programs:** You could consider schools that support multilingualism or include courses in Latvian/English.

Some Questions to Ask Yourself:

- Do I want to go to university later?
- Am I more academic or more hands-on?
- What subjects or fields interest me most (e.g. business, technology, arts, trades)?
- Do I want to start working sooner or study longer?

Example Paths:

Interest Area	Suggested Path
University, unsure yet	STX
Business, maybe start my own	HHX
Tech, engineering, IT	HTX or EUX (tech field)
Becoming a skilled worker (e.g. mechanic, carpenter)	EUD or EUX

Interest Area	Suggested Path
Want to study abroad	IB or STX with strong language focus

If you tell me more about your interests or career dreams (even just what subjects you like in school), I can give you a more tailored recommendation.